

The Hockey Player

By

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INT. SMALL APARTMENT - NIGHT

FADE IN

DAVE, a struggling actor in his late-20s, sits in his cramped bachelor's apartment scanning the ads in Backstage. He stumbles on an ad of interest.

"WANTED: MALE HOCKEY PLAYER FOR PIZZA COMMERCIAL"

Dave glances over at his hockey gear in the corner. Enticed, he reads the rest of the ad.

"FULLY PAID. ACTING EXPERIENCE NOT NECESSARY. CALL NUMBER BELOW."

"*MUST BE WILLING TO TRAVEL TO **MEXICO** FOR THE SHOOT!"

DAVE

Mexico?

EXT. PUBLIC PHONE - NIGHT

Dave finishes dialing and anxiously waits. After a few rings...

MEXICAN MAN (V.O.)

Hola?

DAVE

Hi. I'm calling about the ad.

MEXICAN MAN (V.O.)

Por favor, no me mates! Tendré la plata el Martes!

DAVE

What? I don't speak Spanish. The ad said you're looking for a hockey player...

MEXICAN MAN (V.O.)

Oh gracias a Dios. No tengo piernas. Sí, *hockey player*. Yes.

DAVE

Right. Uh huh. Yes, I can go to Mexico.

TITLE: "THE HOCKEY PLAYER"

EXT. MEXICIAN TOWN - DAY

A bus pulls away, leaving Dave in a deserted town. Hockey gear in hand, he searches for signs of human life. An old crone sitting in a rocking chair is the only person around.

He shows the ad to her. She laughs at him and points down the road. She continues to laugh at him as he walks away.

INT. RUNDOWN OLD HOUSE - DAY

Dave approaches and knocks on the door. Unlocked, it swings open. He enters. The house is unfurnished and looks abandoned.

DAVE

Hello?

There is a sleeping man slumped in a chair in the living room.

DAVE (cont'd)

Excuse me, sir...

No response. Dave steps closer and notices the man is tied to the chair. Blood is dripping from his hand. Dave turns to exit.

Blocking his exit is JJ, a dirty wild man dressed in rags. JJ growls and scampers on all fours towards Dave.

DAVE (cont'd)

Whoa whoa whaaa!!!

JJ tackles him to the ground and grabs him by the lapels.

JJ

Ooka mani pic tu!?

DAVE

What?! I don't understand!

JJ pulls out a large knife and threatens Dave with it.

JJ

Ju ku to mani!!

DAVE

I don't know what you're saying! Please! I'm just here to act!!

ELLIS, a neatly-dressed, effeminate man with a British accent enters the room and pulls JJ off of Dave.

(CONTINUED)

ELLIS
OK, OK, that's quite enough.

JJ
Gallo tu ky-wakka!

DAVE
What is he saying?

ELLIS
I don't know. It's a made-up
language. He's had too much tree
bark today.
(to JJ)
Go to your cage!

JJ scurries away to the kitchen, into a large dog cage. He
eats from a bowl overflowing with Cheez-its.

ELLIS (cont'd)
Sorry about that. He always gets
excited before a shoot.

DAVE
(pointing to dead man)
Did he... kill that guy?

ELLIS
That guy? Oh, he was there when we
got here. Can I help you with
something?

DAVE
I think there's some kind of
mistake. I answered an ad in the
paper and the guy on the phone gave
me this address.

ELLIS
Ah, yes! You must be our hockey
player.

DAVE
Yes. Finally. Thank you. I was
beginning to think this was just a
scam.

ELLIS
(laughing)
A scam? Yes, we actually just want
your organs. The movie is just a
front.

Ellis laughs again and Dave nervously joins in.

(CONTINUED)

ELLIS (CONT'D)
Right this way. We've already begun
shooting.
(chuckling, to himself)
A scam... That's too funny.

Ellis leads Dave to the back exit.

EXT. BACKYARD - DAY

Ellis hands Dave off to KENT, a flamboyant production
assistant.

ELLIS
Here's one more, Kent.

KENT
(catty)
Oh, you're *all business* today.

ELLIS
(sternly whispers)
I told you. Not at work.

Kent looks away, disgusted. Ellis exits.

KENT
(after a sigh)
So you're the hockey player?

DAVE
Yeah.

KENT
Hmmm. Kinda thin. OK whatever.
We'll make it work. Let's just get
you into make up. Here's your
script. Don't worry about
memorizing it.

DAVE
OK. I brought my hockey gear with
me...

KENT
Oh, that's cute. OK, you can put it
on but Jean Jorge will probably
make a few changes on set.

DAVE
Jean Jorge?

CUT TO:

(CONTINUED)

Dave emerges from the house wearing full hockey gear and skates. He waddles over to the set.

On a concrete patio area, MARISA, 20s, very attractive, is reclined on a lawn chair reading a magazine. Dave stands beside her.

An old film camera on a tripod is facing them. Behind it, Ellis waits next to an empty director's chair. Kent is also nearby, giving eyes at Ellis.

DAVE (cont'd)
(to Marisa)
Hi, I'm Dave.

Marisa ignores him.

DAVE (cont'd)
Hey, have you read this script? It doesn't make any sense.

MARISA
(sighs)
It never does. Jean Jorge doesn't believe in scripts.

DAVE
Who is Jean Jorge?

ELLIS
Quiet on set!

Everyone looks to the house. A man exits, walks over, and sits in the director's chair. It's JJ from before but now he's nicely dressed and wearing sunglasses. He plops into his chair, looking too cool for school.

DAVE
He's the director??

JJ whispers to Ellis.

ELLIS
Ok, Dave. Why don't you skate around a bit.

DAVE
But... there's no ice.

JJ looks irritated.

ELLIS
Yes, dear, we know. Please just
skate. We're rolling.

Dave struggles to skate on the concrete. JJ looks intrigued.
He whispers something to Ellis.

ELLIS (cont'd)
Dave, that's great. Can you just
take off the gloves.

Dave obliges. JJ whispers.

ELLIS (cont'd)
And the jersey.

Dave hesitates but obliges. JJ whispers.

ELLIS (cont'd)
Dave, the wardrobe isn't masculine
enough. We're going to try
something else.

CUT TO:

ELLIS (CONT'D)
Perfect!

Dave is now wearing daisy dukes and a short mesh tank top; a
misguided epitome of male sexuality. He looks uncomfortable.

ELLIS
OK, Dave, jump for us.

Dave struggles to hop in his skates. JJ whispers continually
to Ellis.

ELLIS (cont'd)
A little higher. OK, now faster.
Hop hop hop. OK now put the stick
between your legs. Yes! Point it at
Marisa. Now hold it. Stroke it.
Faster! Look like you love it! Oh,
you love it so much!

Exhausted, Dave stops.

DAVE
OK, look this is not what I signed
up for. I thought this was a pizza
commercial? There isn't even any
pizza around here.

(CONTINUED)

JJ stands and walks over. Everyone is silent and watching. He steps up to Dave and removes his sunglasses. He speaks with an unidentifiable European accent.

JJ
You wanna fuck my movie?

DAVE
Uh..

JJ
Are you trying to fuck my movie?

DAVE
N-No I'm not trying to fuck your movie. I just, I don't know what-

JJ pulls a knife and presses it on Dave's throat.

JJ
No one fuck my movie. Understand?

DAVE
Y-Yes, sir.

JJ returns to his chair and whispers to Ellis.

ELLIS
OK, Dave. Hop Hop Hop.

Dave hops.

A montage shows Dave dancing and doing martial arts in his ice skates while JJ and Ellis continue to give direction. Dave cries. JJ threatens with his knife. Ellis shouts directions and Kent bats his eyes and blows kisses. Marisa just reads her magazine. Dave looks scared and exhausted by the end.

ELLIS (cont'd)
OK Dave, great job. We're nearly there. We've got one more scene, a love scene with Marisa.

Dave perks up a little. He smells himself.

DAVE
Do you think we could stop for a moment so I can freshen up a bit for the lady?

ELLIS

No need for that Dave. Just lie down on the floor and Marisa will do all the work. OK Marisa, get on your mark.

Dave and Marisa get into position. JJ waves his hand.

ELLIS (cont'd)

And...Shit on his chest!

Marisa half-squats over Dave and begins removing her shorts but Dave suddenly gets up.

DAVE

OK, hold on! I think I made a mistake. I'm not the right guy for this job. I think I'm just gonna take off.

ELLIS

Really?

DAVE

Yeah, I'm sorry. I don't mean to fuck your movie. I just really want to go home.

JJ whispers once more.

ELLIS

OK. If that's what you want. You can grab your things and go.

DAVE

OK great.
(to JJ)
I'm very sorry, sir.

ELLIS

It's fine. We got most of the shots we needed. We'll just take your kidney and you can be on your way.

DAVE

Thanks I-- wait my what?

Kent grabs Dave and holds him. Ellis approaches with a knife.

DAVE (O.S)

Wait. No! This is a scam?! Oh God.
No, please God! No! Aghh!
Agggghhhhhh!!

JJ aims the camera at them and zooms in. The screams and horrible sounds put a smile on his face.

INT. MOVIE THEATER - NIGHT

Dave's screams continue as an audience sits in rapt awe watching JJ's film. A nerdy MOVIE BUFF looks like he is enjoying it but his date is not.

"THE END" flashes on the screen and there is a polite applause. The movie buff gives a standing ovation.

EXT. STREET - NIGHT

The movie buff and his date exit the theater.

MOVIE BUFF

Absolutely brilliant. 5 stars. Jean
Jorge does it again!

They pass a display with the movie poster. It shows an artsy image of Dave on the floor looking pale and afraid. The title reads "Le Joueur de Hockey."

A man in a trench coat standing near the poster overhears the movie buff's comment. It's Dave, looking sick and homeless. He scoffs at the poster and grumpily mumbles to himself. Using his broken hockey stick as a cane, he slowly limps away to the sound of The Lonely Man theme.

FADE OUT